Next CMS user guide

Every dashboard screen, public route, and builder component.

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User guide: start here

How this guide is organised and the fastest way to build your first page.

How the guide is organised

- **Dashboard**: one article per screen of the admin dashboard.
- **Public site**: the URLs visitors use, and how to sign in.
- **Builder components**: every block in the page builder, grouped as in the insert panel.

Your first page in five minutes

1. Sign in and open **Pages → New page**.
2. Choose the *Builder* editor and a starter template.
3. Replace the text on the canvas and swap the images from the media library.
4. Check the mobile view, then choose **Publish**.
5. Add the page to the header menu under **Menus**.

Other formats

Read the whole guide on one page at /user-guide/print, or download it as a PDF.

Dashboard home

Your starting point: recent content, quick actions, and the site switcher.

Where: `/dashboard`

What you see

- Recent pages and posts, with their status and who changed them last.
- Quick actions to create a page, post, or form.
- The *site switcher* in the sidebar, which picks the site every other screen works on.

Getting around

The sidebar groups screens into Content, Design, Data, and Settings. Screens you have no permission for are hidden, so an Author sees fewer items than an Admin.

Tip: Switch sites first if you manage more than one; lists only show the current site.

Pages

Create, edit, publish, and schedule the pages of your site.

Where: `/dashboard/pages`

Create a page

1. Open **Pages** and choose **New page**.
2. Enter a title. The slug is filled in for you and can be changed.
3. Pick an editor: *Builder* for visual layouts, or *Rich text* for simple documents.
4. Optionally start from a page template.
5. Save. The page opens in the editor you picked.

Status, scheduling, and visibility

- **Draft** pages are only visible in the dashboard and in preview links.
- **Published** pages are live at their slug.
- Set a **scheduled** date and the scheduled publish job makes it live for you.
- Mark one page as **Home** and one as **Blog index** in the page settings.

SEO and taxonomy

Each page has an SEO tab with title, description, Open Graph image, and a no-index switch. Categories and tags help organise pages and drive template rules.

Tip: Use the preview link to share a draft with someone who has no dashboard account.

Page builder

Design pages visually by dragging blocks onto the canvas.

Where: `/dashboard/pages/[id]/builder`

The editor layout

- **Insert panel** (left): every block, grouped by category. Drag one onto the canvas or click to append it.
- **Canvas** (centre): the live page. Click a block to select it; drag its handle to move it.
- **Inspector** (right): the selected block's content, layout, and style settings.
- **Layers**: an outline of every block, useful for selecting nested items.

Saving and publishing

1. Changes autosave as a draft revision.
2. Use the device switcher to check desktop, tablet, and mobile.
3. Choose **Publish** to make the draft live. Earlier versions stay in the revision history.

Editing locks

Only one person can edit a page at a time. If someone else has it open you will see their name and can choose **Take over**.

Tip: Use the Layers panel to select blocks nested deep inside containers.

Rich text editor

Write simple pages and posts as formatted documents.

Where: `/dashboard/pages/[id]/editor`

Formatting

- Headings, bold, italic, links, lists, quotes, and code.
- Paste from other editors; formatting is cleaned up on paste.
- Insert images from the media library.

When to use it

Use rich text for legal pages, articles, and anything that is mostly words. Switch to the builder when you need columns, sections, or interactive blocks.

Posts

Write blog posts with excerpts, featured images, categories, and tags.

Where: `/dashboard/posts`

Write a post

1. Open **Posts** and choose **New post**.
2. Write the body, then add an excerpt and a featured image.
3. Pick categories and tags; they build the category and tag archives.
4. Publish now, or schedule a date.

Layouts

- **Template** layout: the post body is placed inside a post template (see Post templates).
- **Custom** layout: open the post builder and design this one post freely.

Where posts appear

Published posts live at `/blog/<slug>`, on the blog index page, and in category, tag, author, and date archives.

Post templates

Control how single posts are laid out.

Where: `/dashboard/posts/templates`

How templates are chosen

1. A post with a *custom* layout uses its own design.
2. Otherwise it uses the template assigned to it.
3. Otherwise it uses the site's default post template.

Editing a template

Templates are built with the Post blocks: Post title, Featured image, Post meta, Post content, and Related posts. Add any other block around them.

Tip: Only one template can be the default. Setting a new default clears the old one.

Collections

Model structured content such as team members, products, or locations.

Where: `/dashboard/collections`

Create a collection

1. Open **Collections** and choose **New collection**.
2. Add fields: text, rich text, number, date, boolean, media, select, or relation.
3. Optionally choose a **template page**; each entry then gets its own public URL rendered with that page.

Entries

Open a collection and choose **Entries** to add items. Entries can be drafts or published, and are available through the Query loop block and the `/api/v1/collections` API.

Tip: Use the Collection item block inside the template page to show a field of the current entry.

Media library

Upload and organise images, video, and documents.

Where: `/dashboard/media`

Uploading

- Drag files onto the library or use **Upload**.
- Images, video, and PDF are accepted.
- Add alt text and a title to every image; screen readers and search engines use them.

Using media

Any image field in the builder opens the library picker. Files are served from `/api/media/…` and can be organised in folders.

Menus

Build the navigation shown in your header and footer.

Where: `/dashboard/menus`

Build a menu

1. Open **Menus** and pick a location: header, footer, or sidebar.
2. Add items with a label and a URL. Drag items to reorder or nest them.
3. Optionally add a badge or open the link in a new tab.
4. Save. The Nav menu and Footer links blocks read the menu for their location.

Languages

Each language can have its own menu for the same location.

Header, footer, search, and archive templates

Design the parts of the site that wrap every page.

Where: `/dashboard/header-footer`

Template types

- **Header** and **Footer**: shown on every page. They have a draft and a published version.
- **Search**: the layout of `/search`.
- **Archive**: the layout of blog category, tag, author, and date listings.

Create and assign

1. Choose **New template**, pick a type, and start from a starter or blank.
2. Design it in the builder with header or footer blocks.
3. Choose **Set as site default**.

Which header is used

The first match wins: a page that hides the header, then the page's own choice, then display rules (post type, category, tag), then the language override, then the site default.

Tip: Add a display rule to give the User Guide category its own header.

Page templates and global blocks

Reuse layouts and keep shared sections in sync.

Where: `/dashboard/templates`

Page templates

A page template is a starting layout offered when you create a page. Changing a template does not change pages already created from it.

Global blocks

A global block is a section you edit once and place on many pages with the Global block element. Editing it updates every page that uses it.

Tip: Good candidates: call-to-action banners, trust bars, and legal notices.

Contact forms and inbox

Build forms and read what visitors send.

Where: `/dashboard/contact-forms`

Build a form

1. Open **Contact forms** and choose **New form**.
2. Add fields and mark the required ones.
3. Place the form on a page with the Global block element.

Inbox

Submissions arrive in **Contact forms → Inbox**. Mark them read, archive them, flag spam, or export all of them to CSV.

Tip: A hidden trap field and the Turnstile check (when configured) flag most spam automatically.

Categories and tags

Group content so visitors and templates can find it.

Where: `/dashboard/taxonomy`

Categories vs tags

- **Categories** are hierarchical. Use them for the main sections of your blog.
- **Tags** are flat and can have a colour. Use them for topics that cut across categories.

Public archives

Each category and tag gets an archive at `/blog/category/<slug>` or `/blog/tag/<slug>`, rendered with the Archive template.

Users and roles

Invite people and control what they can do.

Where: `/dashboard/users`

Roles

- **Admin**: everything, including settings and users.
- **Editor**: all content, templates, and media.
- **Author**: their own posts and pages.
- **Viewer**: read-only access to the dashboard.

Managing people

Invite a user by email, give them a role, and choose which sites they belong to. Inactive or locked users cannot sign in. When admin approval is on, new sign-ups wait here until approved.

Tip: Edit a role to fine-tune its permissions screen by screen.

Sites

Run several sites from one dashboard.

Where: `/dashboard/sites`

Adding a site

1. Open **Sites** and choose **New site**.
2. Give it a name, a slug, and optionally a domain.
3. Choose its languages and default language.
4. Add members. Content, menus, and settings are separate for each site.

How visitors reach a site

A site is matched by its domain first, or by its slug as the first path segment when path routing is on.

Site settings

Name, branding, SEO defaults, sign-in, and more.

Where: `/dashboard/settings`

General

- Site name, description, URL, logo, and favicon.
- Default SEO title, description, and Open Graph image.
- Header and footer menus, and the default site templates.
- robots.txt and the Google Analytics id.

Sign-in settings

Turn password, magic-link, and Google sign-in on or off, require admin approval, and set the session lifetime and lockout rules. These apply to the whole install.

Theme

Colours, fonts, spacing, and radius for the whole site.

Where: `/dashboard/theme`

Design tokens

The theme is a set of tokens: brand colours, text and surface colours for light and dark mode, font families, sizes, radius, and spacing. Every block uses these tokens, so one change restyles the site.

Tip: Check both light and dark previews before saving.

Licenses

Issue and manage license keys for products you sell.

Where: `/dashboard/licenses`

License keys

- Issue a key with a product, plan, seat limit, and expiry date.
- See every installation that activated the key, and revoke one if needed.
- Client apps call `/api/licenses/activate`, `validate`, and `heartbeat`.

This install’s license

Settings → License shows the license of this CMS install itself.

Videos

Organise videos into playlists and show them on your site.

Where: `/dashboard/videos`

Adding videos

1. Create a playlist.
2. Add videos by pasting a YouTube, Vimeo, or file URL; the title and thumbnail are fetched for you.
3. Publish them, then show them with the Video library block.

Progress

Signed-in viewers resume where they stopped; progress is stored per user.

Redirects

Send old URLs to new ones.

Where: `/dashboard/redirects`

Adding a redirect

Enter the old path and the new path, and choose **301** (permanent) or **302** (temporary).

Tip: Add a redirect whenever you change a published page’s slug, so links and search rankings keep working.

Review queue

Approve content before it goes live.

Where: `/dashboard/review`

How review works

1. An author submits a page or post for review.
2. Editors see it in the review queue with a preview and the changes.
3. Approve to publish, or send it back with a note.

Analytics

Page views, top content, referrers, and A/B tests.

Where: `/dashboard/analytics`

Boards

Analytics boards are dashboards you build from widgets: views over time, top pages, referrers, and experiment results. Open a board and choose **Edit** to arrange widgets.

Experiments

Create an A/B experiment on a page to show a variant to part of your visitors and compare results.

API keys

Read and write content from other apps.

Where: `/dashboard/api`

Creating a key

Create a key, choose its scopes (for example `content:read`), and copy it. It is shown only once. Send it as a Bearer token to `/api/v1/…`. The full reference is at `/api/v1/openapi`.

Tip: Give each integration its own key so you can revoke one without breaking the others.

Webhooks

Webhook subscriptions call your URL when content is published or a collection entry changes. Each delivery and its response status are recorded.

Your account

Your profile, password, and two-factor authentication.

Where: `/dashboard/account`

Security

- Change your name, email, and password.
- Turn on two-factor authentication with an authenticator app.
- See and sign out of your active sessions.

Public site routes

Every URL a visitor can open, and what renders it.

Where: `/`

Routes

- `/` : the page marked as Home.
- `/<slug>` : any published page.
- `/blog` : the page marked as Blog index.
- `/blog/<slug>` : a single post, laid out by its post template.
- `/blog/category/<slug>`, `/blog/tag/<slug>`, `/blog/author/<id>`, `/blog/archive/<yyyy-mm>` : archives, laid out by the Archive template.
- `/search?q=…` : search results, laid out by the Search template.
- `/<lang>/…` : the same routes in another language.
- `/user-guide/print` : this guide as one printable page.

Previews

Preview links show draft content to anyone with the link until it expires. An admin bar appears for signed-in editors with a shortcut back to the editor.

Signing in

Password, magic link, and Google sign-in.

Where: `/login`

Ways to sign in

- **Email and password**, with optional two-factor code.
- **Email me a link**: a one-time magic link.
- **Login with Google**, when it is turned on in settings.

Lockouts

Too many failed attempts lock the account for a while. An admin can unlock it from the Users screen.

Heroes and calls to action

Big, attention-grabbing sections for the top and bottom of a page.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Hero

Open a page with a headline, a short pitch, and one or two buttons.

Settings: Badge, title, subtitle, button labels and links, image, alignment.

Can: Eyebrow, title, and lead text · Primary and secondary buttons · Background image or color

Call to action

Ask visitors to take one clear next step, usually near the end of a page.

Settings: Badge, title, description, two buttons, variant (gradient, primary, subtle).

Can: Title and supporting text · One or two buttons · Section background styles

Marketing blocks

Sections that explain and sell: features, numbers, prices, and social proof.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Features

Explain what your product does in short, scannable items.

Settings: Eyebrow, title, subtitle, columns, items with icon, title, and description.

Can: Icon, title, and text per item · Two to four columns · Responsive stacking

Stats

Back up a claim with a few strong numbers.

Settings: Headline, items with value, label, and change.

Can: Value and label per stat · Even column layout

Pricing

Compare plans side by side.

Settings: Monthly/yearly toggle, plans with price, features, button, and a highlighted plan.

Can: Monthly and yearly toggle · Highlighted plan · Feature checklist per plan

Testimonials

Show what customers say about you.

Settings: Quote, author, role, and company per item.

Can: Quote, author, and role · Avatar images

FAQ

Answer common questions without a wall of text.

Settings: Question and answer per item.

Can: Collapsible answers · Keyboard accessible

Logo cloud

Show customers or partners at a glance.

Settings: Title and a logo image per item.

Can: Image per logo · Optional grayscale

Team

Introduce the people behind the site.

Settings: Photo, name, and role per person.

Can: Photo, name, and role · Responsive grid

Timeline

Tell a story in steps or show a roadmap.

Settings: Date, title, and text per milestone.

Can: Date, title, and text per step · Vertical layout

Content blocks

Text, media, and embeds for any page.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Rich text

Headings, paragraphs, lists, and links. Edit the text directly on the canvas.

Settings: Content and width.

Can: Headings, lists, and links · Inline formatting · Edit on the canvas

Image

A single picture with alt text and an optional caption or link.

Settings: Image, alt, caption, aspect ratio, size, fit, link.

Can: Media library picker · Alt text and caption · Responsive sizing

Gallery

A grid of images that open in a lightbox.

Settings: Columns, gap, images.

Can: Several images · Column count · Lightbox

Video

Embed one YouTube, Vimeo, or file video.

Settings: Video URL.

Can: YouTube, Vimeo, or file URL · 16:9 responsive frame

Video library

A browsable list of videos from your playlists.

Settings: Sources, title, search, layout, playlist, page size.

Can: Playlist filter · Sidebar or stacked layout · Pagination

Embed

Third-party widgets such as a booking calendar. The HTML is sanitized.

Settings: Embed URL.

Can: Sanitized HTML embed · Responsive frame

Map

Show where you are.

Settings: Address.

Can: Address or coordinates · Zoom level

Code

Share a code snippet with syntax highlighting and a copy button.

Settings: The code to show.

Can: Language selection · Copy button

Newsletter

Collect email sign-ups.

Settings: Title and subtitle.

Can: Title and description · Email capture

Contact form block

Collect messages from visitors.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Contact form

A form whose submissions land in the Contact forms inbox.

Settings: Title, fields (label, name, type, required), submit text, success message.

Can: Configurable fields · Spam protection · Submission emails

Blog and listing blocks

Dynamic lists of posts, pages, collection entries, and videos.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Query loop

List posts, pages, collection entries, or videos and design the card yourself.

Settings: Source, layout (grid, list, masonry, carousel, table), columns per device, sorting, page size, pagination, locked category or tag; a Card slot and an Empty state slot.

Query filter

Search, category, tag, and sort controls for a Query loop on the same page.

Settings: Target loop id and which controls to show.

Loop item field

Inside a Query loop card: show one field of the current item.

Settings: Field (title, excerpt, image, date, author, terms, read more, custom) and link to item.

Search results

The results list on the Search template.

Settings: Title, placeholder, tabs, thumbnails, type badges, snippets, page size.

Blog posts

A ready-made list of recent posts with optional filters. Use Query loop when you need a custom card.

Settings: Layout, columns, page size, filters, locked category or tag.

Can: Category and tag filters · Grid or list layout · Pagination

Layout blocks

Structure: boxes, columns, and interactive containers that hold other blocks.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Container

A flex or grid box that holds any blocks. The building block of custom layouts.

Settings: Mode (flex/grid), direction, gap, alignment per device, HTML tag.

Can: Flex and grid layouts · Per-device direction and alignment · Custom HTML tag

Columns

Two to four columns side by side that stack on mobile.

Settings: Ratio (1-1, 1-1-1, 2-1…), gap, vertical alignment.

Can: Preset column ratios · Gap and vertical alignment · Stacks on mobile

Slider

Slides with arrows and dots; each slide holds any blocks.

Settings: Slides; each slide holds any blocks.

Can: Blocks inside each slide · Arrows, dots, and autoplay

Tabs

Switch between panels of content.

Settings: Tab labels; each tab holds any blocks.

Can: Blocks inside each tab · Keyboard navigation

Accordion

Collapsible panels for long or optional content.

Settings: Panel titles; each panel holds any blocks.

Can: Blocks inside each panel · Single or multiple open

Button

A link styled as a button.

Settings: Label, link, alignment.

Can: Label and link · Style variants and sizes

Spacer

Add vertical breathing room.

Settings: Height.

Can: Adjustable height

Image morph

Images that blend into one another as the visitor scrolls.

Settings: Morph images.

Can: Several images · Scroll-driven transition

Collection blocks

Show data from collection entries.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Collection item

On a collection template page: show a field of the current entry.

Settings: Field, layout, label, text size, alignment.

Can: Bound to a collection field

Global blocks

Reuse one section across many pages.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Global block

Place a shared global block or contact form. Edit the original once and every page updates.

Settings: Which global block.

Can: Edit once, update everywhere · Pick any saved global block

Post template blocks

Available in post templates and custom post layouts. They show the current post.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Post title

The current post’s title, optionally with excerpt and back link.

Settings: Back link, excerpt, alignment.

Featured image

The current post’s featured image.

Settings: Aspect ratio.

Post meta

Author, date, categories, and tags of the current post.

Settings: Which parts to show.

Post content

The body of the current post. Every post template needs one.

Settings: Width.

Related posts

More posts that share categories or tags.

Settings: Title, limit, columns.

Header blocks

Available in header templates.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Header bar

The main header row with left, centre, and right areas.

Settings: Width, layout, background, padding, height, border.

Can: Logo, navigation, and actions · Sticky and transparent modes

Header columns

A header split into up to six columns.

Settings: Columns, gap, stacking breakpoint.

Logo

Your logo, linking home. Can swap for dark mode and sticky headers.

Settings: Source, images, width, link, site name.

Nav menu

Links from a menu location, with dropdowns.

Settings: Menu location, orientation, depth, dropdown trigger, active style.

Mobile menu

A hamburger menu for small screens.

Settings: Breakpoint, drawer side, menu location, icon, search.

Search box

A search field that opens /search.

Settings: Mode, placeholder, live results, alignment.

Announcement bar

A thin notice above the header, such as a sale or launch.

Settings: Text, link, dismissible, and a start and end date.

Social icons

Links to your social profiles.

Settings: Networks and URLs, shape, size.

Contact info

Phone, email, and address.

Settings: Items, icons, layout, alignment.

Theme toggle

Lets visitors switch between light and dark mode.

Settings: Icon.

Language switcher

Switch between the site’s languages.

Settings: None; it lists the site’s languages.

Footer blocks

Available in footer templates.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Footer columns

The footer layout, split into up to six columns.

Settings: Columns and gap.

Footer links

A titled group of links, from a menu or typed in.

Settings: Heading, source, menu location, links.

Copyright

A copyright line. `{year}` and `{site_name}` are filled in for you.

Settings: Text and alignment.

Legal links

Privacy, terms, and cookie links.

Settings: Source, menu location, links, separator.

Back to top

A button that scrolls to the top of the page.

Settings: Position, when to appear, icon, label.

Custom blocks

Blocks added by developers in `src/builder/custom`.

Every block also has

A **Section** group (padding, background, anchor, hide on mobile/tablet/desktop) and a **Style** group for colours, typography, borders, and spacing of its parts.

Badge

A small label such as “New”. A custom block example.

Settings: Set in code.

Card

A simple card with title and text. A custom block example.

Settings: Set in code.